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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA Closed (47427.12)

NASDAQ Closed (23214.69)

STOXX 600 575.00 ▲ 0.1%

10-YR. TREAS. Closed (3.997%)

OIL Closed (\$58.65)

GOLD Closed (\$4165.20)

EURO \$1.1596

YEN 156.31

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Prosecutors said** authorities in Taiwan raided the homes of Intel executive Wei-Jen Lo, as part of an investigation into whether the engineer improperly transferred technology related to national security. **A1**

◆ **Billionaire investor** Todd Boehly, a part-owner of the Los Angeles Dodgers, joined the race to acquire the international assets of Lukoil, the sanctions-hit Russian energy company. **B1**

◆ **JPMorgan Chase said** it would construct London's largest office block, choosing as its site Canary Wharf in the city's docklands. **B1**

◆ **A rebound in** artificial-intelligence stocks continued to boost Asian markets, while in Europe the Stoxx 600 benchmark and the FTSE 100 were essentially flat. **B9**

◆ **Vanke's proposal** to delay repayment of an onshore bond led to trading halts in three other local notes and triggered a selloff in shares of Chinese property developers. **B9**

◆ **The SEC rejected** Dream Exchange's application for a license to run a stock exchange after the startup's undisclosed financial ties to the Church of Scientology were revealed. **B1**

◆ **Campbell's said it fired** the executive allegedly caught on audio disparaging the company's products. **B3**

◆ **Google's YouTube TV** and TelevisaUnivision signed a multiyear deal that will return the Spanish-language broadcaster's channels to YouTube TV's subscribers. **B4**

◆ **Tesla will double** the number of robotaxis in Texas in December, less than six months after the company launched the service. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **U.S. Army Spc.** Sarah Beckstrom, one of the National Guard soldiers targeted by a gunman in Washington, D.C., died, Trump said, calling the shooting suspect a "savage monster." **A1, A7**

◆ **Putin said** the White House's 28-point proposal for peace in Ukraine took into account Russia's perspective and was a good starting point for further discussions, but described it as a list of questions requiring work. **A6**

◆ **Dozens of Jeffrey Epstein** victims' names were exposed in documents recently made public by Congress, setting off a legal dispute about the Justice Department's plans to release more related materials. **A3**

◆ **A Georgia judge dropped** the election-interference case against Trump and his inner circle, ending a legal battle to hold the president criminally responsible for alleged interference in the 2020 vote. **A3**

◆ **A panel of judges** allowed North Carolina to use a redrawn congressional map aimed at flipping a seat to Republicans as part of Trump's multistate redistricting campaign. **A5**

◆ **Trump urged** Japan's prime minister not to provoke Beijing on the question of Taiwan's sovereignty after the president spoke with his Chinese counterpart. **A9**

◆ **Hundreds of thousands** of Haitians are set to lose their legal protections and work permits in February with the expiration of Haiti's designation under the Temporary Protected Status program. **A4**

◆ **Died: Robert A.M. Stern**, 86, acclaimed architect. **A5**

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Slinging Cheer at Thanksgiving Day Parade



MARVEL-OUS: Handlers guided the Spider-Man balloon past Radio City Music Hall—and thousands of spectators—during the annual Macy's-sponsored tradition in midtown New York City on Thursday, part of celebrations across the country.

Intel Executive's Residences Raided in Probe Over Secrets

Engineer's move to U.S. chip maker from TSMC fuels security concerns in Taiwan

By YANG JIE

Intel, the struggling chip maker now part-owned by the U.S. government, recently made an executive hire: Wei-Jen Lo, a Taiwanese engineer who has led some of the industry's biggest manufacturing breakthroughs.

But before Lo can help re-

store the U.S.'s semiconductor champion to its former glory, he must deal with a criminal investigation in Taiwan that has turned his job switch into a case with geopolitical implications.

Taiwanese prosecutors said on Thursday that authorities raided Lo's residences in Taiwan and seized evidence including at least one computer as part of an investigation into whether Lo improperly transferred technology related to national security.

Prosecutors said a court approved their request to

freeze real estate and other assets held by Lo.

His previous employer, global chip-making leader Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing, said the executive violated noncompete and confidentiality agreements when he jumped ship. TSMC this week said it was suing Lo and alleged he may bring trade secrets to Intel.

An Intel representative said: "Based on everything we know, we have no reason to believe there is any merit to the allegations involving Mr. Lo." The company said it had

strict controls over the transfer of confidential information. Lo couldn't be reached directly.

President Trump led a U.S. move to take a 10% stake in Intel. Washington is pressuring Intel to rebuild domestic chip production, backing it with government subsidies.

The White House has voiced concern about Taiwan's dominance in semiconductor manufacturing, and Trump has repeatedly criticized Taiwan's chip industry, saying it stole business from the U.S.

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Hong Kong Fire Toll Climbs

Officials on Thursday searched for clues about what sparked a massive blaze at a densely packed apartment complex that killed at least 94 people the day before. **A9**



VERNON YUEN/NEOPHIM IMAGES/ZUMA PRESS

Strikes Don't Deter Drug-Boat Crews

By JUAN FORERO

CALI, Colombia—They see themselves as the cowboys of the drug trade, highly experienced crews that ferry narcotics on small boats across the open seas, running on a mix of bravado, skill and dreams of a massive payday.

Now, designated as terror-

ists by the Trump administration, they face not only the perils of a capricious sea but also the new danger of getting blown out of the water by the U.S. military. The trade's unofficial motto—"deliver or die"—has never rung so true.

Three men who have manned these drug boats spoke to The Wall Street Jour-

nal, describing an essential part of the narcotics trade that is now in President Trump's sights.

They run drug cargoes worth as much as \$70 million on sleek 40-foot-long boats, often built from fiberglass and powered by oversize outboards. Called go fasts, these

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Sewer Flowers Land Artist In Hot Water

* * *

Sioux City rallies around 'Manhole Michelangelo'

By JOE BARRETT

SIoux CITY, Iowa—Brandon Bradshaw eyed a manhole cover from different angles before bending his lanky frame to spray-paint a series of arcs in slashing strokes on the street around it. After about 30 minutes, he had completed his latest work—a neon-tinged bloom of color about 10 feet across. "It sounds stupid, but the flowers kind of decide what they

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Germany Dusts Off Preparations for War

Plans for potential conflict with Russia update old Cold-War mindset

By BERTRAND BENOIT

BERLIN—A dozen senior German officers convened at a military compound in Berlin about 2½ years ago to work on a secret plan for a war with Russia. Now they're racing to implement it.

Russia's 2022 full-scale invasion of Ukraine ended decades of stability in Europe. Since then, the region has embarked on its fastest military buildup since the end of World War II. But the outcome of a future war won't

depend only on the number of troops and weapons in the field.

It will also hinge on the success of the monumental logistical operation at the heart of Operation Plan Germany, the 1,200 page-long classified document drafted behind the nondescript walls of the Julius Leber Barracks.

The blueprint details how as many as 800,000 German,

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◆ **Putin says U.S. plan to end war needs work**..... **A6**

National Guard Soldier Shot in D.C. Dies

Second victim is in critical condition; Afghan man faces charges in ambush

U.S. Army Spc. Sarah Beckstrom, one of the National Guard troops targeted by a gunman in Washington, D.C., on Wednesday has died, according to President Trump.

By Gareth Vipers,
Gavin Bade
and Sadie Gurman

"She's just passed away," Trump said during a Thanksgiving call for servicemembers. "She's no longer with us. She's looking down at us right now. She was savagely attacked, she's dead," Trump said, adding the other victim was fighting for his life.

He called the shooting suspect a "savage monster."

The suspect, 29-year-old Rahmanullah Lakanwal, an Afghan national, previously worked with CIA-backed military units during the U.S. war in Afghanistan, the agency said.

Trump showed a picture of the suspect and displayed another photo of people crammed into an airplane in Afghanistan during the botched U.S. withdrawal from the country. "This is what we had under the Biden administration," he said.

Speaking of the alleged killer, Trump said: "He went cuckoo. I mean, he went nuts."

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◆ **West Virginia towns rally around victims**..... **A4**

Lighter Regulation Makes U.S. Mergers A Much Bigger Deal

By DAVE MICHAELS
AND BEN GLICKMAN

Corporate tie-ups are surging under Trump 2.0.

Companies are more willing to take a shot at deals that merge direct competitors, bankers and lawyers say, thanks in part to the Trump administration's more lax approach to enforcement.

The Justice Department and Federal Trade Commission, which share antitrust authority, have sued to block just three mergers since Republican leaders took over at the two agencies this year. They sued to block an average of six deals a year during President Joe Biden's term. In the second half of his term, enforcers focused more on monopolization cases.

"People are encouraged and willing to take more risk, willing to entertain bigger deals,"

said Oliver Smith, co-head of mergers and acquisitions for law firm Davis Polk.

That has prompted an increase in deal volume. Deal value in the U.S. this year is up more than 40% from the same period in 2024 to about \$1.9 trillion, according to data from LSEG. And there have been roughly twice as many deals valued above \$10 billion than in the same period in 2024.

Dealmakers say several of the high-profile tie-ups proposed or announced likely wouldn't have been attempted under the prior administration.

A \$71.5 billion deal for railroad Union Pacific to buy Norfolk Southern would create the country's first coast-to-coast rail operator. Nexstar Media Group's bid to buy rival broadcaster Tegna would cre-

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INSIDE



SPORTS
Oklahoma City's lowest-paid player leads the Thunder to new heights. **A16**



MANSION
Unassuming Cashiers, N.C., is the village that billionaires have come to love. **M1**